

Document Checklist & Legal Binder Guide

KNOWLEDGE. RIGHTS. ACTION.

Disclaimer: This worksheet is for educational purposes only and is not legal advice. Every case is different. Consult a qualified attorney when possible.

Use this guide to build an organized packet. A court can review your request more easily when documents are labeled, ordered, and explained.

Binder label: _____ Case / Docket #: _____

1 CASE SUMMARY (COVER SHEET)

- ☐ One-page summary: who you are, case number, court, sentence, what you are requesting
- ☐ Table of contents listing each section below
- ☐ Pages: _____ to _____

2 COURT & SENTENCING RECORDS

- ☐ Judgment / sentencing order
- ☐ Information or key charging documents
- ☐ Prior appellate or post-conviction decisions
- ☐ Pages: _____ to _____

3 EDUCATIONAL ACHIEVEMENTS

- ☐ Program completion certificates
- ☐ Transcripts, diplomas, GED
- ☐ Teacher or program coordinator letters
- ☐ Pages: _____ to _____

5 TREATMENT & COUNSELING

- ☐ Substance abuse treatment completion
- ☐ Mental health or counseling records (as allowed)
- ☐ Evaluations or progress reports
- ☐ Pages: _____ to _____

6 CONDUCT & INSTITUTIONAL RECORD

- ☐ Disciplinary history (complete and accurate)
- ☐ Positive recognitions, awards, or achievements
- ☐ Program participation logs
- ☐ Pages: _____ to _____

7 CHARACTER & COMMUNITY SUPPORT

- ☐ Family letters
- ☐ Mentor, clergy, or employer letters
- ☐ Program staff recommendations
- ☐ Pages: _____ to _____

8 MEDICAL (IF APPLICABLE)

- ☐ Diagnosis or treatment summary
- ☐ Provider letters (as appropriate)
- ☐ Pages: _____ to _____

9

REENTRY PLAN

- ☐ Housing plan
- ☐ Employment plan
- ☐ Support system (family, programs, services)
- ☐ Short- and long-term goals
- ☐ Pages: _____ to _____

10

MOTION & FILING DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Draft or final motion
- ☐ Personal statement
- ☐ Required court forms
- ☐ Proof of service (when filed)
- ☐ Pages: _____ to _____

✓

QUALITY CHECK (BEFORE SUBMITTING)

- ☐ Every section has a tab or divider label
- ☐ No duplicate documents in multiple sections unless cross-referenced
- ☐ Every document is readable (no dark photocopies)
- ☐ Sensitive information is included only when relevant
- ☐ A friend or advocate has reviewed for clarity (if possible)



MASTER DOCUMENT LIST

DOCUMENT	SECTION #	DATE	HAVE IT? (Y/N)